

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 9 7
 ♥ Q J T 8 3
 ♦ A 8
 ♣ 7 5 3

14
 7 7
 12

♠ 6
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ K J 9 7 4
 ♣ A Q J 9 2



♠ A K 5
 ♥ 7
 ♦ Q T 6 5 3
 ♣ K T 8 4

♠ Q J 8 4 3 2
 ♥ A 9 6 5 2
 ♦ 2
 ♣ 6

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 19

NORTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are

missing two Aces!

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
All Pass			
5♦ by North			

Deal 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 7 3
 ♥ A J 8 6
 ♦ 5 3
 ♣ 8 7

8
 12 16
 4

♠ 9 8 6 2
 ♥ 4 2
 ♦ K Q J T
 ♣ Q 6 3



♠ T 5
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ 9 8 4 2
 ♣ K J T 9 2

♠ K 4
 ♥ K Q T 9 5
 ♦ A 7 6
 ♣ A 5 4

West

1 ♠

3 ♥

5 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by East

North

Pass

Pass

Pass

East

2 ♥

4NT

6 ♥

South

Pass

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 20

EAST knows WEST has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three

of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, WEST comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces EAST knows there are not enough points for Grand,

so she bids 6

♥

.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 4
♥ 8 4 3
♦ Q J 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

16
3 6
15

♠ A 6 2
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 6
♣ K Q J T 9



♠ K 5 3
♥ A T 9 5 2
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 4

♠ Q J 9 8
♥ 6
♦ K T 8 7 3 2
♣ 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by South			

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When NORTH answers Blackwood with one Ace SOUTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, NORTH would bid 6



.

But she knows that if she does so, SOUTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, NORTH figures her ♣ suit will

supply five tricks so she bids 7



Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 5
 ♥ A J 6 5 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ K Q J

4
 20 11
 5

♠ J 9 3
 ♥ K 3
 ♦ 8 7 4 3
 ♣ 9 5 4 2



♠ T 6 4 2
 ♥ T 8
 ♦ A J T 9 2
 ♣ 7 6

♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 9 7 4
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ A T 8 3

West

1♥

4NT

5♥

All Pass

5♥ by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

3♥

5♦

South

Pass

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 22

WEST thinks there might be slam if EAST holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When EAST shows just one Ace WEST is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so

he stops at 5

♥

.

It turns out that WEST might make twelve tricks, depending on the

♥

K situation.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ 9 6 3
♦ T 9 5 4 3
♣ T 8 5

18
2 4
16

♠ A J 6
♥ K 5
♦ A Q 6 2
♣ A 9 7 4



♠ K 4 2
♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2
♦ K
♣ K 3

♠ T 9 7 5 3
♥ T
♦ J 8 7
♣ Q J 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

7NT by North
Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

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SOUTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam

in



s. He chooses to temporize with a 1



response and is rewarded when NORTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents SOUTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine.

When he discovers that NORTH holds three

Deal 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K
♥ K Q 4
♦ K Q J 3
♣ K Q J 5

4
24 10
2

♠ 9 8 5 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A T 8

♣ 9 7 4 2



♠ J T 7 2

♥ J 6 5 3 2

♦ 7 6 4

♣ 3

♠ Q 6 3

♥ A T 7

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A T 8 6

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EAST responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with
no 5-card suit.

WEST only needs to know how many Aces are
in the EAST hand. He must use Gerber since

4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When EAST shows two Aces WEST bids
6NT.

West

2♣

4♣

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

North

Pass

Pass

East

2NT

4♠

South

Pass

Pass